

What else to watch: *Los Olvidados* (1950, p.332) ■ *Pather Panchali* (1955, pp.132–33) ■ *Central Station* (1998, p.285) ■ *City of God* (2002, pp.304–09)



The movie delves back into earlier moments in Jamal's life, showing how he learned each answer. The audience learns his life story in a series of flashbacks, each corresponding to a question. It begins with the moment when Jamal is five and he and his brother Salim are fleeing the 1992–93 Bombay Riots. They run into young Latika, who will become the love of his life. The story reveals other moments in which Jamal and Salim use their wits to survive everything from chilling encounters with gangsters who maim street children to Jamal's heartache over Latika. But will it be enough to convince the police inspector to set him free, and to find his sweetheart?

Mixed reception

The reception of *Slumdog Millionaire* in the West was overwhelmingly positive. The movie bubbles with feel-good energy and a raucous joie

The nation watches enthralled as Jamal (Dev Patel) progresses through the rounds with correct answers, heading for the 20 million rupee jackpot.

de vivre. Cinematographer Anthony Dod Mantle, using digital cameras to their fullest potential, puts the audience right in the heart of frantic, vibrant Mumbai. An exuberant Bollywood-style dance at a train station only further cranks up the adrenaline.

The movie was showered with acclaim, eventually winning eight Oscars, including Best Picture and Best Director for Boyle. And yet in India and elsewhere, some felt *Slumdog* had only gained recognition because it had a British director, while "real" Indian movies were ignored. Others felt that its view of the Mumbai slums was unrealistic and that the rags-to-riches plot was implausible. ■

“We used to live right there, man. Now, it's all business.”

Jamal / Slumdog Millionaire



Danny Boyle Director

Known for his versatility, ability to work in many genres, and kinetic camera angles, Danny Boyle made his name directing tough, funny movies with pulsating sound tracks. Born in Lancashire, UK, in 1956 to Irish parents, he was brought up Catholic and considered entering the priesthood. Instead, he studied English and Drama at Bangor University in Wales, becoming a theater director and working at the Royal Shakespeare Company and the Royal Court. In 1987, he started working in TV, producing many TV movies. He claims that his love for movies started with *Apocalypse Now* (1979): “It had eviscerated my brain completely.” His first feature movie, the black comedy *Shallow Grave*, was a UK hit. Two years later, *Trainspotting*, a stylish movie about drug addicts in Edinburgh, propelled him to international attention.

Key movies

1994 *Shallow Grave*
1996 *Trainspotting*
2002 *28 Days Later*
2007 *Sunshine*
2008 *Slumdog Millionaire*